

0.0.1 Sakka's Questions (excerpt)

1. "Do you, O Ruler of the devas, recall having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas?"
2. "I do recall, O Bhante, having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas."
3. "But, O Ruler of the devas, if it is not troublesome for you, speak as to how they answered."
4. "It is not troublesome for me, O Bhante, of where the Auspicious One is seated or someone like the Auspicious One."
5. "Well then, O Ruler of the devas, speak."
6. Those who, O Bhante, that I conceived to be "Samanas and brahmanas who are forest dwellers in secluded resting places," to them I approached. Having approached, I asked these questions. They were not able to answer the questions asked. Being unable to answer, they asked me a question in return: "What is your name venerable sir?" When asked, I answer to them: "I, Dear sir, am Sakka, Ruler of the devas." They then asked a further question of me: "But having done what kamma, O venerable sir, was it possible for you to attain this rulership of the devas?" To them I taught the dhamma as I have

heard and learned it. They surely became pleased with just that much [rejoicing]: “We have seen Sakka, Ruler of the devas and he has answered the questions we asked him.” “Those on the other hand become my disciples, instead of I being theirs. But I, O Bhante, am a disciple of the Auspicious One, a stream-enterer, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

7. “Do you recall, O Ruler of the devas, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

8. “I do recall, O Bhante, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here.”

9. “But you, O Ruler of the devas, in what way do you recall having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

10. Once in the past, O Bhante, the devas and the asuras were arrayed for a battle. And in that battle, O Bhante, the devas were victorious and the asuras were defeated. Of me, O Bhante, having been victorious in that battle, as a victor in battle, this occurred: “Now, just that which is the food of the devas, and that which is the food of the asuras, the devas will enjoy them both.” But for me

O Bhante, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the sphere of violence, in the sphere of swords, does not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. But for me O Bhante, having heard this Dhamma of the Auspicious One, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness not in the sphere of violence, not in the sphere of swords, leads exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana,”

11. “But considering what benefit, do you, O Ruler of the devas, declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness?”

12. “Considering six benefits, O Bhante, do I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.”

“Remaining just here,
for me existing as a deva being;
yet gained is renewed life for me,
You should know thus, dear Sir.”

13. Seeing this first benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

Having passed from the deva group,

having abandoned the non-human life;
unconfused, I will enter a womb,
where my mind delights.

14. Seeing this second benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

That I, with unconfused wisdom,
dwelling delighting in the Instructions;
will dwell by the know-how,
contemplative and mindful.

15. Seeing this third benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

And faring by the know-how,
if there will be supreme awakening;
I will dwell as one with final knowledge,
and just that will be the end.

16. Seeing this fourth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

Having passed away from the human group,
having abandoned the human life;
I will again become a deva,

in the highest deva world [sudhāvāsa].

17. Seeing this fifth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

Those that are more sublime than the devas,
the glorious Akaniṭṭha [realm];
that will be my abode,
my final state of being.

18. Seeing this sixth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

19. Seeing these six benefits, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.